

The 12-bar blues map every chord option in 18 forms, simplest first

Key of F, concert pitch

Bars 1–4
I, or something
standing in for it

F7	1
FA	I7 1–9
F#– B7	IA7 10–15 17
C–/F	#i–7 #IV7 16 I9sus 18

F7	2
Bb7	IV7 17 1–9
E– Eb–	IV7 3–9
BbΔ	vii–7 bVII–7 11
E– A7	IVΔ7 12 13
F#– B7	vii–7 III7 10 14–16
F–/Bb	#i–7 #IV7 17 IV9sus 18

F7	3
D– Db–	I7 17 1–6
A– G–	vi–7 bvi–7 11
D– G7	iii–7 ii–7 12 13
EA EbΔ	vi–7 II7 10 14–16
C–/F	VIIΔ7 bVIIΔ7 17 I9sus 18

F7	4
C– F7	v–7 I7 7–10 14 16
C– B7	v–7 #IV7 11
F#– B7	#i–7 #IV7 12 13 15
DbΔ BΔ	bVIIΔ7 #IVΔ7 17
C–/F	I9sus 18

Bars 5–8
IV, then back
toward I

Bb7	5
BbΔ	IV7 1–10
F–/Bb	IVΔ7 11–17 IV9sus 18

Bb7	6
Eb7	IV7 1–5
B°	bVII7 6–8
Bb–	#iv°7 10
B– E7	iv–7 11 12
Bb– Eb7	#iv–7 VII7 9 17
Bb– E7	iv–7 bVII7 13 14 16
F–/Bb	iv–7 VII7 15 IV9sus 18

F7	7
F7 E7	I7 VII7 9
A– D7	iii–7 VI7 10
A–	iii–7 8 11 12 14 15
AbΔ	bIIIΔ7 13 16
AA	IIIΔ7 17
C–/F	I9sus 18

F7	8
D7	I7 1–3
Eb7 D7	VI7 4–6 8
Ab–	bVII7 VI7 9
A– D7	biii–7 11 12
Ab– Db7	iii–7 VI7 7 17
C–/F	biii–7 bVI7 10 13–16 I9sus 18

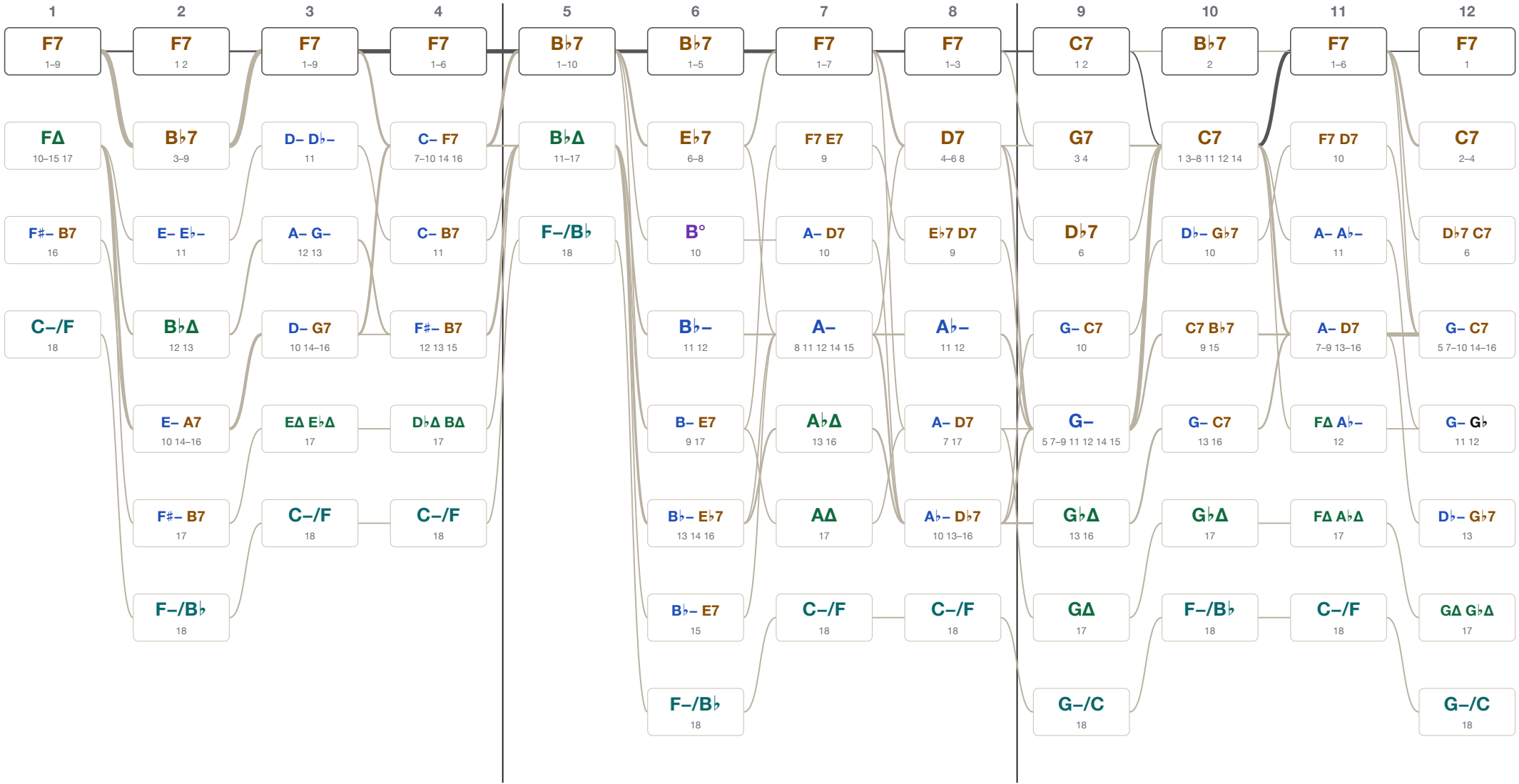
Bars 9–12
V (or a ii–V),
home to I

C7	9
G7	V7 1 2
Db7	II7 3 4
G– C7	bVI7 6
G–	ii–7 V7 10
GbΔ	ii–7 5 7–9 11 12 14 15
GΔ	bIIΔ7 13 16
G–/C	IIΔ7 17 V9sus 18

Bb7	10
C7	IV7 2
Db– Gb7	V7 13–8 11 12 14
C7 Bb7	bvi–7 bII7 10
G– C7	v7 IV7 9 15
GbΔ	ii–7 V7 13 16
F–/Bb	bIIΔ7 17 IV9sus 18

F7	11
F7 D7	I7 17 1–6
A– Ab–	I7 VI7 10
A– D7	iii–7 biii–7 11
FA Ab–	iii–7 V7 7–9 13–16
FA AbΔ	IA7 biii–7 12
C–/F	IA7 bIIIΔ7 17 I9sus 18

F7	12
C7	I7 1
Db7 C7	V7 2–4
G– C7	bVI7 V7 6
G– Gb	ii–7 V7 5 7–10 14–16
Db– Gb7	ii–7 bII 11 12
GΔ GbΔ	bvi–7 bII7 13
G–/C	IIΔ7 bIIΔ7 17 V9sus 18



Form	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
1 Basic blues	F7	F7	F7	F7	B♭7	B♭7	F7	F7	C7	C7	F7	F7
2 V–IV cadence	F7	F7	F7	F7	B♭7	B♭7	F7	F7	C7	B♭7	F7	C7
3 Quick four + II7	F7	B♭7	F7	F7	B♭7	B♭7	F7	F7	G7	C7	F7	C7
4 VI7–II7–V7 chain	F7	B♭7	F7	F7	B♭7	B♭7	F7	D7	G7	C7	F7	C7
5 Diatonic ii–V	F7	B♭7	F7	F7	B♭7	B♭7	F7	D7	G–	C7	F7	G– C7
6 IV of IV + tritone subs	F7	B♭7	F7	F7	B♭7	E♭7	F7	D7	D♭7	C7	F7	D♭7 C7
7 ii–V into IV; iii–VI–ii–V	F7	B♭7	F7	C– F7	B♭7	E♭7	F7	A– D7	G–	C7	A– D7	G– C7
8 iii– in bar 7	F7	B♭7	F7	C– F7	B♭7	E♭7	A–	D7	G–	C7	A– D7	G– C7
9 Chromatic dominants	F7	B♭7	F7	C– F7	B♭7	B– E7	F7 E7	E♭7 D7	G–	C7 B♭7	A– D7	G– C7
10 Bird blues	FΔ	E– A7	D– G7	C– F7	B♭7	B°	A– D7	A♭– D♭7	G– C7	D♭– G♭7	F7 D7	G– C7
11 Chromatic minor sevenths	FΔ	E– E♭–	D– D♭–	C– B7	B♭Δ	B♭–	A–	A♭–	G–	C7	A– A♭–	G– G♭
12 Major sevenths + chromatic minors	FΔ	B♭Δ	A– G–	F#– B7	B♭Δ	B♭–	A–	A♭–	G–	C7	FΔ A♭–	G– G♭
13 ii–Vs to ♭III and ♭II	FΔ	B♭Δ	A– G–	F#– B7	B♭Δ	B♭– E♭7	A♭Δ	A♭– D♭7	G♭Δ	G– C7	A– D7	D♭– G♭7
14 Blues for Alice style	FΔ	E– A7	D– G7	C– F7	B♭Δ	B♭– E♭7	A–	A♭– D♭7	G–	C7	A– D7	G– C7
15 Tritone-sub ii–V into IV	FΔ	E– A7	D– G7	F#– B7	B♭Δ	B♭– E7	A–	A♭– D♭7	G–	C7 B♭7	A– D7	G– C7
16 ii–V chain from bar 1	F#– B7	E– A7	D– G7	C– F7	B♭Δ	B♭– E♭7	A♭Δ	A♭– D♭7	G♭Δ	G– C7	A– D7	G– C7
17 Major-seventh planing	FΔ	F#– B7	EΔ E♭Δ	D♭Δ BΔ	B♭Δ	B– E7	AΔ	A– D7	GΔ	G♭Δ	FΔ A♭Δ	GΔ G♭Δ
18 Sus-chord blues	C–/F	F–/B♭	C–/F	C–/F	F–/B♭	F–/B♭	C–/F	C–/F	G–/C	F–/B♭	C–/F	G–/C